

ProofHire

Performance-Based Hiring · Trust Infrastructure for Talent

Idea Submission · In response to Olumide Balogun, Zovaya Corporation · March 2026

Hiring is broken — not because great talent is scarce, but because trust in that talent is absent. ProofHire replaces the resume with verifiable, real-world proof of skill: a performance infrastructure that lets ability speak louder than credentials.

01 · PROBLEM STATEMENT

The global hiring system operates on an outdated trust model. Resumes are self-reported and frequently inaccurate. Technical interviews are inconsistent, subjective, and rarely reflect actual on-the-job performance. The result is a market where companies make expensive mis-hires — losing up to 30% of an employee's annual salary per bad placement — while highly capable individuals remain overlooked due to a lack of pedigree or network access.

This is not a talent shortage. It is a trust problem — and no current platform solves it at the infrastructure level.

02 · PROPOSED SOLUTION

ProofHire is a performance-based hiring platform that replaces the traditional resume with verifiable proof of skill. Candidates complete real-world technical challenges — debugging systems, building features, optimizing code — under conditions that mirror actual job demands. Their results are compiled into a dynamic Skill Profile: a living, data-driven record that employers can verify, trust, and act on.

Employers post real tasks and hire directly from the ranked results. No screening calls. No guesswork. Just demonstrated performance.

03 · TARGET USERS & MARKET

Candidates (Supply Side)	Employers (Demand Side)
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- Self-taught & bootcamp developers
 - CS students & recent graduates
 - Junior-to-mid technical talent globally
- Remote-first startups & scale-ups
 - SMEs hiring globally without HR infra
 - Outsourcing & staffing agencies

Initial focus: remote-first companies hiring across borders, where the gap between claimed and actual ability is widest — and where willingness to pay for verification is highest.

04 · TECHNOLOGY APPROACH (HIGH-LEVEL)

- **Secure Execution Environment:** Containerized sandboxes run candidate code safely, capturing performance signals — correctness, efficiency, style, and problem-solving approach.
- **Dynamic Skill Graph:** A continuously updated profile mapping each candidate across domains: APIs, backend performance, scalability, data structures, and security.
- **Automated Scoring Engine:** AI-assisted evaluation of code quality, approach, and output against real-world benchmarks — not arbitrary test cases.
- **Employer Matching Dashboard:** Ranked, filterable candidate results tied directly to the employer's specific challenge, enabling fast, confident hiring decisions.
- **Future Enhancements:** Adaptive testing, anti-cheating mechanisms, and behavioral analysis to further close the gap between assessment and real performance.

05 · REVENUE MODEL

Revenue Stream	Description
Hiring-as-a-Service	Flat fee or percentage per successful hire facilitated through the platform
Employer Subscriptions	Monthly/annual access to verified talent pools, challenge analytics, and ranked pipelines
Sponsored Challenges	Companies fund branded challenges to source and identify top talent proactively
Premium Candidates	Paid visibility upgrades and advanced assessments for job-seekers
Marketplace Commission	Take-rate on freelance/project-based engagements facilitated through the platform

06 · WHY I AM THE RIGHT PERSON TO BUILD THIS

I am a Software Engineering student who has lived this problem firsthand. I know what it means to be skilled without the credentials to prove it — and to watch opportunities go to candidates who interview well rather than perform well. That experience is not just context; it is the founding conviction behind ProofHire.

Beyond personal motivation, I have the technical foundation to architect and build this system: backend APIs, secure code execution environments, data pipelines for skill tracking, and employer-facing dashboards. I understand both sides of the hiring equation — what candidates need to demonstrate ability, and what employers need to hire with confidence.

I am prepared to begin execution immediately, iterate fast on user feedback, and validate the model through real hiring outcomes — not projections. My goal within the first 60 days: onboard 50-100 developers, run live challenges, and produce the first verified hire through the platform.

ProofHire is not competing with job boards.

It is replacing the resume as the primary signal of ability.

I welcome the opportunity to develop this further in partnership with Zovaya Corporation.